

ITEC630 - Week 2

Project Management & Risk Management: Hands-on Tutorial Activity

Duration: 1:30 Hour

Objective:

This tutorial will provide students with practical experience in project management and risk assessment within an IT project environment. Students will engage in two structured activities based on a case study, allowing them to apply theoretical concepts in a real-world setting.

Case Study 1: IT Startup – AI-driven Learning Platform (45 minutes)

A newly launched tech startup is developing an AI-powered online learning platform. The company has a small development team and a limited budget. The platform aims to use machine learning and natural language processing to personalise user learning experiences. However, the project faces significant challenges, including tight deadlines, evolving requirements, and limited risk mitigation strategies.

Activity 1: Project Planning Discussion (30 minutes)

Objective: Develop a structured project plan for the AI-driven learning platform.

Instructions:

1. Form Teams: Students will be divided into small groups (3–5 members). Each group will assume the role of the project management team.
2. Define Key Planning Elements: Discuss and outline the following project planning components:
 - Project objectives and deliverables.
 - Project phases and timeline (breakdown of tasks and milestones).
 - Resource allocation (team roles, technology, and budget constraints).
 - Monitoring and reporting mechanisms to track project progress.
3. Presentation: Each team will present their project plan briefly (5 minutes per team).

Discussion Questions:

- How would you allocate tasks among team members?
 - What challenges might arise in project execution, and how would you address them?
 - How will you ensure that the project stays within budget and timeline?
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Activity 2: Risk Identification and Mitigation (45 minutes)

Objective: Identify potential risks and develop mitigation strategies for the project.

Instructions:

1. Risk Analysis Discussion: Each group will brainstorm and categorise possible risks under the following types:
 - Project Risks: Delays in development, lack of technical expertise.
 - Product Risks: AI model underperformance, usability issues.
 - Business Risks: Competition, investor pull-out, regulatory challenges.
2. Risk Assessment: Groups will evaluate the likelihood and impact of each risk using a simple risk matrix:
 - Probability: Low, Medium, High.
 - Impact: Minor, Moderate, Severe.
3. Mitigation Strategies: Develop risk management plans for high-priority risks:
 - Risk avoidance strategies.
 - Contingency plans.
 - Monitoring approaches.
4. Class Discussion: Each team shares one major risk and their proposed mitigation plan.

Discussion Questions:

- What are the most critical risks in this project?
- How can proactive planning reduce unexpected project failures?
- How can risk assessment improve decision-making in IT projects?

Expected Learning Outcomes:

- Understand the importance of structured project planning in IT development.
- Develop practical skills in risk assessment and mitigation strategies.
- Enhance teamwork and problem-solving abilities through real-world case analysis.
- Improve communication and decision-making skills in a project management setting.

This hands-on activity will help you bridge the gap between theory and practice, preparing you for real-world project management challenges in IT.